"I've never lost nor ever accepted defeat"



In a freewheeling chat at his Lucknow residence, Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath spoke to Group Editorial Director Raj Chengappa and Special Correspondent Prashant Srivastava on his re-election prospects. Excerpts from an exclusive interview

Q. You have been chief minister for five years. Why should people vote for you again?

Whatever we—that is the Bharatiya Janata Party—promised, we delivered. Secondly, the benefits of a double-engine government have come as a double dose for the state, whether of vaccine or of food grains, of saving lives and livelihood or of ensuring safety and prosperity. Only the BJP can ensure it, and all this has been achieved under the leadership of [Prime Minister Narendra] Modiji. Voices coming out of village after village indicate that the BJP will form the government again on March 10, 2022 with a thumping majority.

Q. What makes you so confident?

Uttar Pradesh has better law and order. There have been no riots in the past five years, stringent government action has been taken against mafias that once controlled the government, we have made strict *bandobust* for the safety of our daughters, investment and employment opportunities have been enhanced, and infrastructure development undertaken. In the past 70 years—from 1947 to 2017—only one and a half expressways had been constructed in the state while we are